

My Mountain

Pedro

My rock.

A gray, moss-

covered boulder,

resting on the quilted

soft grass, unmoved for

millions and trillions of years.

Seen generations upon generations

of a family of squirrels in the tree next

door. Raised the tree from sapling to giant.

Snow

-capped

rugged

mountains

with stern bush

roots squeezing tight

the crevices and snaking

through the steep cliffside.

Born to be a watchguard and protector of the land / Standing through time, still.

You've been there for me / cast your shade on me / shielding me from the harsh rays

of the biting sun and the stalking vultures waiting ready to pounce / held me with your

arms raised high / helped me reach higher highs than I could alone / as I climbed atop your

shoulders / my boulder / and surveyed the lush valley floor spread vast across every dimension,

peering at the view between bouts of our laughter / the corners of your eyes crinkling as you smile \

I felt invincible standing on top of you, then within your arms, and eventually, finally, just next to you \

Remember when I used to wait for you when you came home from work, hide around the corner, and jump
out to scare you? I felt that way then, too / invincible / as if nothing could scratch my skin or bruise my heart \

I used to shadow you in the summertime / stuffy garage / performing surgery on your Toyota Camry older than me \

You grunted "pass me the screwdriver" / and as I did as you told / I still feel the calluses of your hands sanding my own \

Like a rock / Like a rock chewing at my hand with its divots and bumps, surface rough and imperfect / I winced in surprise, but

I was comforted / reminded of a rock that had been beaten and battered, eaten away by the eagerness of wind and water over ages,

yet softened and mellowed by the test of time / tenured with wisdom and understanding as it had seen life come and go, come and go \

You saw me trip on the branches and stumble on the pebbles as I tried to hike to the summit, but you caught me with your arms open wide \

See me now, on top of this world, if only for a moment / I'm away from you now, standing on you, yelling loud into the void my ecstasy and joy \

One day, Dad, I'll hike down the mountain, and you won't be under me / I worry / I might be lost without you there, always, as my sturdy foundation \